Review Cards

Turning errors into future retrieval

Use Review Cards to turn corrected errors into a personal retrieval resource. Separate the question from the solution so students can attempt it again without seeing the answer.

How to do it well

1 Select the error. Choose a consequential gap from a quiz, assessment or mock, prioritising a confidently held mistake where useful.

2 Write the front. Copy a complete question or prompt that can be answered independently.

3 Build the back. Record the topic, original mistake, corrected method and annotations that explain the crucial decision.

4 Add support. Include a specific reference for help or further practice, checking that the solution is accurate.

5 Use the deck. Attempt the front before checking the back; revisit incorrect cards sooner and return to secure cards after a longer interval.

What this sounds like

“Put the question on the front. On the back, record the topic, your mistake, a corrected worked example and the note that would help you avoid it next time.”

Classroom example. A pupil turns a confidently incorrect quiz item into a card. The front contains the question; the back explains the mistake, corrected method and where to find more practice. Later, the pupil attempts the front before turning it over. An incorrect attempt returns sooner in the deck rather than disappearing after the original correction.

Top tips that make the technique work

Begin with a high-confidence error. It identifies an important mismatch between certainty and correctness.

Annotate for the future self. Include why the decisive step works and what caused the original mistake.

Add a help reference. Link to an appropriate worked example, revision resource or practice location.

Quiz before turning over. Looking at the solution first turns the card into rereading.

Return errors sooner. A simple deck routine can revisit incorrect cards before secure ones without needing a complex system.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Keep the question and solution on opposite sides.	A card containing only a final answer.
Revisit the cards through independent attempts.	Making cards that students never use for retrieval.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

Barton — Walking-Talking Mock Exams: Review Cards | Barton Low-stakes quiz